



The Bug Life Cycle

The Journey of a Defect

Tags: QA, Workflow, Process

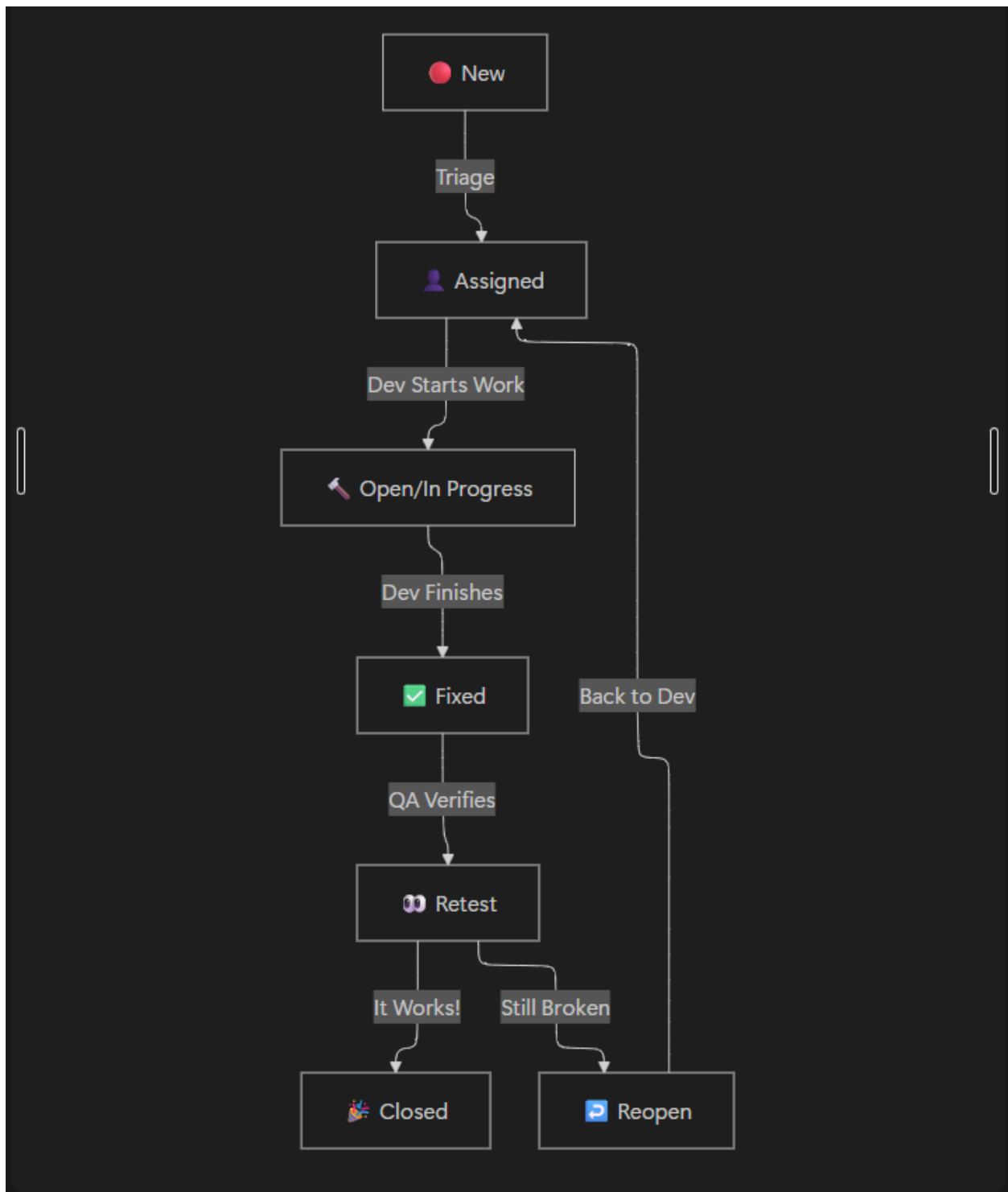
Reading Time: 3 min

TL;DR (Too Long; Didn't Read)

A bug doesn't just go from "Found" to "Fixed."

It travels through specific states: **New** ➡ **Assigned** ➡ **Fixed** ➡ **Retest** ➡ **Closed**.

The Workflow Diagram



🤖 The Stages Explained

1. 🟡 New

The bug is found and logged by the QA. It hasn't been looked at yet.

2. Assigned

The Lead Developer or Manager reviews the bug and assigns it to a specific developer to fix.

3. Open / In Progress

The developer is actively writing code to fix the issue.

4. Fixed / Resolved

The developer says, "I have fixed it." They push the code and move the ticket to this state.

Note: The bug is NOT closed yet. It is just waiting for QA.

5. Retest

The QA tester picks up the ticket. They check if the fix actually works (as we discussed in the "Sanity Testing" article).

6. Verified / Closed

The QA confirms the fix works. The bug is officially dead. No more work is needed.

7. Reopen

If the QA tests it and the bug is **still there**, the ticket is not closed. It is **Reopened** and sent back to the developer with comments like "Still reproducing on build 1.2."

The "Rejection" States

Sometimes, a developer will **not** fix a bug. They might move it to:

- **Duplicate:** "Someone else already reported this."
- **Rejected / Not a Bug:** "This is how it's supposed to work (It's a feature, not a bug)."
- **Deferred:** "This is a real bug, but it is low priority. We will fix it in the next release, not this one."